

Consultee Comments for Planning Application 25/01011/OUT

Application Summary

Application Number: 25/01011/OUT

Address: Land to The West of Sladburys Lane Clacton On Sea Essex CO15 6NU

Proposal: Outline Planning Application (all matters reserved) - Up to 30 dwellings plus associated infrastructure including a new access onto Sladburys Lane.

Case Officer: Amy Lang

Consultee Details

Name: Mr Clive Dawson

Address: Tendring District Council, Clacton Town Hall, Station Road Clacton On Sea, Essex CO15 1SE

Email: Not Available

On Behalf Of: Tree & Landscape Officer

Comments

The application site is partly in agricultural use and partly used for a temporary yard associated with the development of adjacent land. There are no trees or other significant vegetation in the main body of the land, however some site boundaries are demarcated by established countryside hedgerows and hedgerow Oaks.

The trees and hedgerows are an integral and intrinsic part of the landscape. The two Oaks on the southwestern boundary are afforded protection by Tendring District Council Tree Preservation Order TPO/15/14

It should be noted that the trees on the northwestern boundary are important features in their setting and are protected by the Forestry Commissions Felling License controls and by the Hedgerow Regulations 1997.

To quantify the amenity value and condition of trees and other vegetation on the perimeter of the application site and adjacent land an Arboricultural Impact Assessment (AIA) has been provided. The AIA contains an assessment of the trees and hedgerows and sets out the extent to which they are a constraint on the development potential of the land.

This information is in accordance with BS5837: 2012 Trees in relation to design, demolition and construction. Recommendations.

The indicative site layout shows that an open space and circular walkway will be created around the perimeter of the site and that there is sufficient separation between the trees and any built development to ensure that the perimeter trees will not be harmed by the implementation of the

proposed development.

Should planning permission be likely to be granted then details of the measures that will be put in place to physically protect trees and hedgerows (a Tree Protection Plan [TPP] and Arboricultural Method Statement [AMS]) should be secured as a reserved matter.

In terms of the potential impact of the proposed development on the local landscape character the application site appears to be situated within the Clacton and The Sokens Clay Plateau Landscape Character Area (LCA) and almost immediately adjacent to the Holland Valley System LCA.

The Clacton and The Sokens Clay Plateau is a gently undulating agricultural plateau drained by The Holland Brook Valley System. It has low gappy hedgerows with occasional hedgerows trees that divide arable fields. It has an urban fringe character that is influenced by nurseries, caravan parks paddocks, holiday parks and industrial areas on the edges of developed land.

The Holland Valley System is in contrast with the flat landscapes of the Tendring Plateau. Country lanes drop down the valley sides and cross streams and the LCA is typically devoid of development.

The application site appears to be relatively typical of the characteristics relating to the edge of The Clacton and The Sokens Clay Plateau LCA although noticeably less so of the Holland Valley System because of the amount of adjacent development.

It is accepted that the character of the application site is influenced by existing adjacent and nearby development and consequently, in landscape terms, has a distinct urban fringe character.

With regard to the assessment of the impact of the proposed development on the local landscape Section 2.3 of the Planning Statement entitled The Sites Spatial Context provides some information relating to the prominence and visual impact of the development on local landscape character. It refers to a Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment (LVIA) relating to an earlier approved development of adjacent land.

Whilst this information is helpful and describes the planning inspectors view of the earlier, third party, application a new site specific LVIA it would be helpful to quantify the level of harm likely to be caused by the current development proposal and to inform measures that may be required to mitigate any identified harm.

This may not require a full LVIA but in order to establish the baseline qualities of the landscape and to assess the level of change and potential harm to the local landscape character some information akin to a Landscape and Visual Impact Assessment (LVIA) should be provided.

In terms of soft landscaping the broad principles set out in Section 5.5 of the Planning Statement are acceptable, however should planning permission be granted then details of soft landscaping, including the retention of boundary vegetation should be secured as a reserved matter.

Soft landscaping should be comprehensive and aim to soften, screen and enhance the appearance of the development.